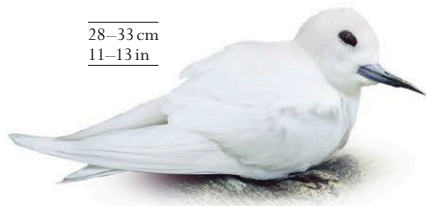


» WADERS, GULLS, AND AUKS

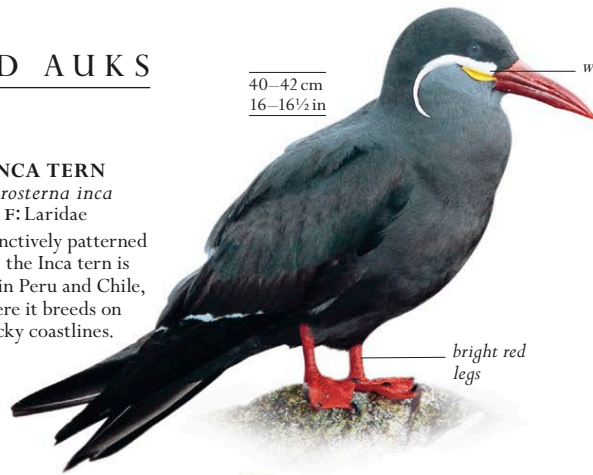


28–33 cm
11–13 in

WHITE TERN
Gygis alba
F: Laridae

This small all-white tern from the islands of the tropical Atlantic and Indian oceans is notable for laying its eggs on bare branches in trees.

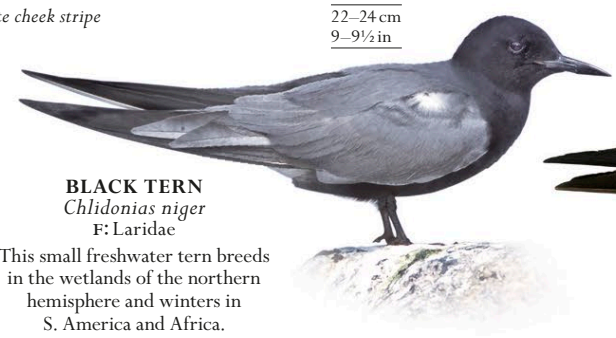
INCA TERN
Larosterna inca
F: Laridae
A distinctively patterned bird, the Inca tern is found in Peru and Chile, where it breeds on rocky coastlines.



40–42 cm
16–16½ in

white cheek stripe

bright red legs



22–24 cm
9–9½ in

BLACK TERN
Chlidonias niger
F: Laridae

This small freshwater tern breeds in the wetlands of the northern hemisphere and winters in S. America and Africa.



LESSER CRESTED TERN
Thalasseus bengalensis
F: Laridae

In this relative of the greater crested tern, the bill changes from yellow to orange during breeding.

35–37 cm
14–14½ in



GREATER CRESTED TERN
Thalasseus bergii
F: Laridae

This Old World tern belongs to a group of related crested terns, characterized by a black nape tuft.

46–49 cm
18–19½ in

black cap

47–54 cm
18½–21½ in



22–24 cm
9–9½ in

LITTLE TERN
Sternula albifrons
F: Laridae

The Old World little tern belongs to a group of coastal species with a white “blaze” above the eye.



SAUNDERS'S TERN
Sternula saundersi
F: Laridae

A small tern from the Red Sea and Indian Ocean, Saunders's tern used to be considered a race of the little tern.

23–24 cm
9–9½ in

black markings
on tips of
underwings



33–36 cm
13–14 in

SOOTY TERN
Onychoprion fuscatus
F: Laridae

This white-blazed sea tern breeds on tropical islands. It is also known as the wideawake tern because of its noisy colonies.

30–32 cm
12–12½ in

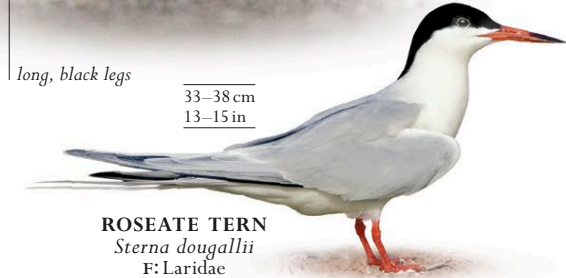


BRIDLED TERN
Onychoprion anaethetus
F: Laridae

This tern of tropical and subtropical regions has a white eye-blaze, similar to little and sooty terns. It spends much of its time at sea.

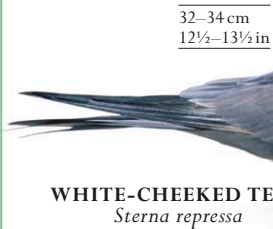
long, black legs

33–38 cm
13–15 in



ROSEATE TERN
Sterna dougallii
F: Laridae

As with related sea terns, the roseate tern's black cap fades in winter. This bird is found mostly in the southern hemisphere and is migratory.



32–34 cm
12½–13½ in

WHITE-CHEEKED TERN
Sterna repressa
F: Laridae

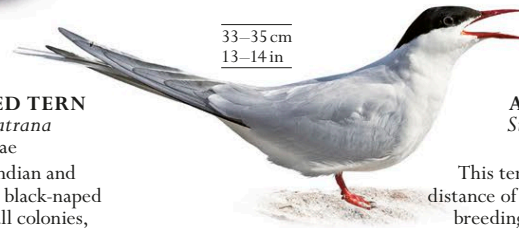
This species from the Red Sea and Indian Ocean can be identified by its plumage, which is darker than that of other grey terns.



30–32 cm
12–12½ in

BLACK-NAPED TERN
Sterna sumatrana
F: Laridae

Found on the Indian and Pacific oceans, the black-naped tern nests in small colonies, usually apart from other terns.



33–35 cm
13–14 in

ARCTIC TERN
Sterna paradisaea
F: Laridae

This tern migrates the greatest distance of any animal: from its Arctic breeding grounds to Antarctica. It feeds on fish and crustaceans.